

### 0.0.1 Vasettha

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Icchanangala in the Icchanangala Forest Grove. At that time many well-known wealthy brahmins were dwelling at Icchānangala, such as: the brahmin Canki, the brahmin Tarukkha, the brahmin Pokkharasati, the brahmin Janussoṇi, the brahmin Todeyya, and many other well-known and wealthy brahmins.

2. Then brahmin youths Vasettha and Bharadvaja while walking and wandering about, walking along back and forth, this talk arose between them: “How indeed is one a brahmin?” The brah-

vāseṭṭhasuttam

evaṃ mesutaṃ: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā icchānaṅgale viharati icchānaṅgalavanasaṇḍe. tena kho pana samayena sambahulā abhiññātā abhiññātā brāhmaṇamahāsālā icchānaṅgale paṭivasanti. seyyathidaṃ: caṅkī brāhmaṇo, tārukko brāhmaṇo, pokkharasāti brāhmaṇo, jānussoṇi brāhmaṇo, todeyyo brāhmaṇo, añño ca abhiññātā abhiññātā brāhmaṇamahāsālā.

atha kho vāseṭṭha-bhāradvājānaṃ māṇavaṇaṃ jaṅghāvihāraṃ anucaṅkamaṇānaṃ anuvicara-

min youth Bharadvaja said thus: “So far as, dear Sir, one is well borne, of pure descent from both the maternal and paternal sides as far back as seven generations, unblemished and irreproachable with regard to ancestry, it is to this extent, dear Sir, that one is a brahmin.” The brahmin youth Vasettha said thus: “So far as, dear Sir, one is virtuous and excels in religious duties, it is to this extent, dear Sir, that one is a brahmin.”. Neither was the brahmin youth Bharadvaja able to convince the brahmin youth Vasettha, nor was the brahmin youth Vasettha able to convince the brahmin youth Bharadvaja.

mānānaṃ<sup>1</sup> ayamantarā kathā udapādi:  
' kathambho brāhmaṇo hoti'ti. bhāradvājo māṇavo evamāha: yato kho bho ubhato sujāto hoti mātito ca pitito ca, saṃsuddhagahaṇiko yāva sattamā pitāmahayugā akkhitto anupakkuṭṭho jātivādena. ettāvata kho bho, brāhmaṇo hoti'ti. vāseṭṭho māṇavo evamāha: 'yato kho bho, sīlavā ca hoti vatasampanno<sup>2</sup> ca. ettāvata kho bho, brāhmaṇo hoti'ti. neva kho asakkhī bhāradvājo māṇavo vāseṭṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ saññāpetuṃ. na pana asakkhī vāseṭṭho māṇavo bhāra-

<sup>1</sup>anucaṇkamantānaṃ anuvicarantānaṃ - machasaṃ, syā. ■

<sup>2</sup>vattasampanno - machasaṃ, simu, syā. ■

3. So then, brahmin youth Vasettha address the brahmin youth, Bharadvaja. Master Bharadvaja, there is this samana Gotama, son of the Sakyans who has gone forth from the Sakyan clan, dwelling at Icchanangala in the Icchanangala Forest Grove. Now a good reputation has been spread about that Auspicious Gotama thus: “Truly is he the Auspicious One, the Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious.” We must visit with the samana Gotama, O Master Bharadvaja. Upon arrival, we must ask the samana Gotama about this matter. In which ever way the samana

dvājaṃ māṇavaṃ  
saññāpetuṃ.

atha kho vāsetṭho  
māṇavo bhāradvā-  
jaṃ māṇavaṃ āman-  
tesi: 'ayaṃ kho bho  
bhāradvāja, samaṇo  
gotamo sakyaputto  
sakyakulā pabbajito  
icchānaṅgale viha-  
rati icchānaṅgalava-  
nasaṇḍe. taṃ kho  
pana bhagavantam  
gotamaṃ evaṃ kal-  
yāṇo kittisaddo ab-  
bhuggato: itipi so  
bhagavā araham  
sammāsambuddho  
vijjācaraṇasampanno  
sugato lokavidū anu-  
taro purisadammasā-  
rathī satthā devama-  
nussānaṃ buddho  
bhagavā'ti. āyāma  
bho bhāradvāja, yena  
samaṇo gotamo te-  
nupasaṅkamissāma.  
upasaṅkamitvā sa-  
maṇam gotamaṃ

Gotama will answer, in just that way we must bear it in mind.”

4. So then, the brahmin youths Vasettha and Bharadvāja visited with the Auspicious One. Having approached, they exchanged friendly greetings with the Auspicious One. Having exchanged friendly greetings and cordial talk, they sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the brahmin youth Vasettha addressed the Auspicious One in verse:

We are accepted and acknowledged,  
as triple knowledge masters;

etamatthaṃ pucchis-  
sāma. yathā no sa-  
maṇo gotamo byā-  
karissati. tathā naṃ  
dhāressāmā'ti. eva-  
bhoti kho bhāradvājo  
māṇavo vāseṭṭhassa  
māṇavassa paccas-  
sosi.

atha kho vāseṭṭha,  
bhāradvājā māṇavā  
yena bhagavā tenu-  
pasāṅkamiṃsu. upa-  
saṅkamitvā bhaga-  
vatā saddhiṃ sam-  
modiṃsu, sammo-  
danīyaṃ kathaṃ  
sārāṇiyaṃ vītisāre-  
tvā ekamantaṃ nisī-  
diṃsu. ekamantaṃ  
nisinno kho vāseṭṭho  
māṇavo bhagavan-  
taṃ gāthāhī ajjha-  
bhāsi:

anuññātapatiññātā,  
tevijjā mayamassu  
bho;  
ahaṃ pokkharasā-

I am Pokkharasāti's student,  
and this is Tārukkha's student.

Of the three knowledges  
which are declared,  
there is perfection [by us];  
from its etymology and grammar,  
we are equal to our teachers in recitation.

For us in regard to ancestry,  
there is a dispute, O Gotama;  
one is a brahmin by birth,

Bharadvaja speaks thus;  
but I say by kamma,  
know thus, O One Endowed with Eyes.

We are both unable,  
to convince one another;  
we have come to question the Auspicious One,

tissa,  
tārukkhasāyaṃ māṇavo.

tevijjānaṃ yadakkhātaṃ,  
tattha kevalino'smase;  
padakasmā veyyākaraṇā<sup>3</sup>,  
jappe ācariyasādisā.

tesaṃ no jātivādasamim,  
vivādo atthi gotama;  
jātiyā brāhmaṇo hoti,  
bhāradvajo iti bhāsati;  
ahañca kammanā brūmi,  
evaṃ jānāhi cakkhuma.

te na sakkoma ñāpetum,  
aññamaññaṃ mayaṃ ubho;

<sup>3</sup>no byākaraṇā - simu ■

the Awakened One renowned  
as such.

As the newly formed  
waxing moon,  
people worship with  
hands in anjali;  
they paying homage to  
the moon,  
so in the world is Go-  
tama;  
the eye arisen in the  
world,  
we ask you Gotama.

Is one a brahmin by  
birth,  
or by kamma;  
tell us, we who do not  
know,  
how we may know a  
brahmin.

For you, I will distin-  
guish,  
one and the other be-  
cause of their species;

bhagavantam puṭṭu-  
māgammā<sup>4</sup>,  
sambuddham iti vissu-  
tam.

candam yathā khayā-  
tītam,  
pecca pañjalikā janā;  
candamānā namas-  
santi,  
evaṃ lokasmiṃ gota-  
mam;  
cakkhum loke samup-  
pannam,  
mayam pucchāma go-  
tamaṃ.

jātiyā brāhmaṇo hoti,  
udāhu bhavati kam-  
manā;  
ajānataṃ no pabrūhi,  
yathā jānemu brāh-  
maṇanti.

tesaṃ vohaṃ vyācik-

<sup>4</sup>puṭṭhumāgamā - machasaṃ;  
puṭṭhum āgammā - syā

the analysis of birth of  
living beings,  
in sequence as it truly is.

Know that the grass and  
trees,  
even though [their birth]  
is not acknowledged;  
their characteristics are  
made from birth,  
one and the other be-  
cause of their species.

Next the moths and grasshop-  
pers,  
up to the biting insects  
and ants;  
their characteristics are  
made from birth,  
one and the other be-  
cause of their species.

Know the four footed too,  
among the small and the  
large;

khissam<sup>5</sup> (vāsetṭhāti  
bhagavā),  
anupubbam yathāta-  
tham;  
jātivibhaṅgam paṇā-  
nam,  
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

tiṇarukkhepi jānātha,  
na cāpi paṭijānare;  
liṅgam jātimayam te-  
sam,  
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

tato kīṭe paṭaṅge ca,  
yāva kunthakipillike;  
liṅgam jātimayam te-  
sam,  
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

catuppadehi jānātha,  
khuddake ca mahal-

<sup>5</sup>vo aham byakkhissam - macha-  
sam ■

their characteristics are  
made from birth,  
one and the other be-  
cause of their species.

Know those that crawl  
with their stomachs  
too,  
serpents, long backed  
crawlers;  
their characteristics are  
made from birth,  
one and the other be-  
cause of their species.

Next know from the  
fishes in water too,  
with water as their pas-  
ture;  
their characteristics are  
made from birth,  
one and the other be-  
cause of their species.

Next know from the birds  
too,  
with wings as vehicles,  
going by the sky;  
their characteristics are  
made from birth,

lake;  
liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ te-  
saṃ,  
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

pādūdarepi jānātha,  
urage dīghapiṭṭhike<sup>6</sup>;  
liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ te-  
saṃ,  
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

tato macchepi jānā-  
tha,  
udake vārigocare;  
liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ te-  
saṃ,  
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

tato pakkhīpi jānātha,  
pattayāne vihaṅgame;

liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ te-  
saṃ,

<sup>6</sup>dighapiṭṭhake - sīma. ■



one and the other be-  
cause of their species.

As among these species,  
there are various char-  
acteristics made from  
birth;  
these various character-  
istics made from birth,

do not exist among hu-  
mans.

Neither by head hairs nor  
by head,  
neither by ear nor by  
eyes;  
neither by face nor by  
nose,  
neither by mouth nor by  
eyebrows.

Neither by neck nor by  
shoulder,  
neither by stomach nor  
by back;  
neither by waist nor by  
breast,  
neither by genitals nor by  
mating.

aññamaññā hī jātiyo.

yathā etāsu jātīsu,  
līṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ pu-  
thu;  
evaṃ natthi manus-  
sesu,  
līṅgaṃ jātamayaṃ pu-  
thu.

na kesehi na sīsehi,  
na kaṇṇehi na akkhīhi;

na mukhena na nā-  
sāya,  
na oṭṭhehi bhamuhi  
vā.

na gīvāya na aṃsehi,  
na udarena na piṭṭiyā;  
na soṇiyā na urasā,  
na sambādhena me-  
thune.

Neither by hands nor by  
feet,  
neither by fingers nor by  
nails;  
neither by calf nor by  
thigh,  
neither by color nor by  
voice;  
certainly there are no  
characteristics made  
from birth,  
as in the case of other  
species.

But among the bodies of  
individuals,  
this [difference] among  
humans is not to be  
found;  
but characteristics among  
humans,  
are for the sake of designation, it is said.

Indeed, whoever among  
humans,  
lives in dependence on  
cow-keeping;  
know him thus, O Vaset-  
tha,

na hatthehi na pā-  
dehi,  
nāṅgulīhi nakhehi vā;  
na jaṅghāhi na ūruhi,  
na vaṇṇena sareṇa  
vā;  
liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ  
neva,  
yathā aññāsu jātisu.

paccattaṃ ca sarī-  
resu,  
manussesvetam na  
vijjati;  
vokāraṇca manus-  
sesu,  
samaññāya pavuccati.

yo hi koci manussesu,  
gorakkhaṃ upajīvati;  
evaṃ vāsetṭha jānāhi,  
kassako so na brāh-  
maṇo.

he is a farmer, not a brahmin.

Indeed, whoever among humans,  
lives in dependence on the various kind of crafts;  
know him thus, O Vasettha,  
he is a craftsman, not a brahmin.

Indeed, whoever among humans,  
lives in dependence on trade;  
know him thus, O Vasettha,  
he is a merchant, not a brahmin.

Indeed, whoever among humans,  
lives in dependence on serving others;  
know him thus, O Vasettha,  
he is a servant, not a brahmin.

yo hi koci manussesu,  
puthusippena jīvati;  
evaṃ vāsetṭha jānāhi,  
sippiko so na brāhmaṇo.

yo hi koci manussesu,  
vohāraṃ upajīvati;  
evaṃ vāsetṭha jānāhi,  
vāṇijo so na brāhmaṇo.

yo hi koci manussesu,  
parapessena jīvati;  
evaṃ vāsetṭha jānāhi  
pessiko so na brāhmaṇo.

Indeed, whoever among  
humans,  
lives in dependence on  
what is not given;  
know him thus, O Vaset-  
tha,  
he is a thief, not a brah-  
min.

Indeed, whoever among  
humans,  
lives in dependence on  
shooting arrows;  
know him thus, O Vaset-  
tha,  
he is a soldier, not a  
brahmin.

Indeed, whoever among  
humans,  
lives in dependence on  
the office of chief priest;  
know him thus, O Vaset-  
tha,  
he is a sacrificing priest,  
not a brahmin.

Indeed, whoever among  
humans,

yo hi koci munussesu,  
adinnaṃ upajīvati;  
evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,  
coro eso na brāhmaṇo.

yo hi koci manusseṣu,  
issatthaṃ upajīvati;  
evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,  
yodhājivo na brāh-  
maṇo.

yo hi koci manusseṣu,  
porohiccena jīvati;  
evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,  
yājako so na brāh-  
maṇo.

yo hi koci manusseṣu,  
gāmaṃ raṭṭhañca

enjoys [the revenue]  
 from the nation and  
 its villages;  
 know him thus, O Vaset-  
 tha,  
 he is a king, not a brah-  
 min.

But I do not call him a  
 brahmin,  
 born of a womb, begot-  
 ten from a mother;  
 he is called a sir-sayer,  
 if he owns something;  
 owning nothing, a dis-  
 owner,  
 it is him I call a brahmin.

He who, having cut all  
 fetters,  
 is truly not perturbed;  
 who is detached with all  
 bonds surmounted,  
 it is him I call a brahmin.

He who having cut de-  
 light and the thong,

bhuñjati;  
 evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,  
 rājā eso na brāhmaṇo.

na cāhaṃ brāhma-  
 ṇaṃ brūmi,  
 yonijaṃ mattisambha-  
 vaṃ;  
 bhovādi nāma so hoti,  
 sace hoti sakiñcano;  
 akiñcanaṃ anādā-  
 naṃ,  
 tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-  
 maṇaṃ.

sabbasaññojanaṃ  
 chetvā,  
 yo ve na paritassati;  
 saṅgātigaṃ visaññut-  
 taṃ,  
 tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-  
 maṇaṃ.

chetvā nandiṃ varat-  
 tañca,  
 sandānaṃ sahanukka-

the tether together with  
the reins;  
the awakened one who  
has raised the cross  
bar,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

He who is not offended  
but forbears,  
abusive speech, beating  
and binding;  
the powerful one with  
the strength of pa-  
tience,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

The one endowed with  
conduct, not inclined  
to anger,  
endowed with virtue, not  
arrogant;  
tamed, bearing his final  
body,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

Like water on lotus leaf,  
like mustard seed on a  
needle tip;  
who is not smeared in  
sensual pleasures,

mam;  
ukkhittapaḷighaṃ  
buddhaṃ,  
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

akkosaṃ vadhāban-  
dhañca,  
aduṭṭho yo titikkhati;  
khaṇṭibalaṃ balāṇi-  
kaṃ,  
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

akkodhanaṃ vatavan-  
taṃ,  
sīlavantaṃ anussa-  
daṃ;  
dantaṃ antimaśārī-  
raṃ,  
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

vāri pokkharapatteva,  
āraggeriva sāsapo;  
yo na lippati<sup>7</sup> kāmesu,

<sup>7</sup>lippi - sīmu, machasaṃ,  
syā

it is him I call a brahmin.

He who wisely under-  
stands suffering,  
has extincted it right  
here by himself;  
who has put down the  
burden, detached,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

The wise one with deep  
wisdom,  
the expert of the path  
and the non-path;  
one attained to the supreme  
goal,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

He who mixes neither  
with householders,  
nor homeless ones alike;  
roaming without abode,  
with fewness of wishes,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

Having layed aside the

tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

yo dukkassa pajā-  
nāti,  
idheva khayamattano;  
pannabhāraṃ viṣaṃ-  
yuttaṃ,  
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

gambhīrapaññaṃ me-  
dhāviṃ,  
maggāmaggaṃ kovi-  
daṃ;  
uttamatthamanuppat-  
taṃ,  
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

asaṃsaṭṭhaṃ gahaṭ-  
ṭhehi,  
anāgārehi cubhayaṃ;  
anokasāriṃ appic-  
chaṃ,  
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

nidhāya daṇḍanaṃ

rod among living beings,  
both the frail and the firm;  
who neither kills nor cause to kill,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

unobstructed among those obstructed,  
extinguished in the taking up of sticks;  
a disowner among owners,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

For whom lust and hate, conceit and denigration  
are laid down;  
like mustard seed on a needle tip,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

He who utters truthful words,  
not harsh, conveying the meaning;  
who does not abuse anyone,

bhūtesu,  
tasesu thāvaresu ca;  
yo na hanti na ghā-teti,  
tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

aviruddhaṃ viruddhesu,  
attadaṇḍesu nibbutaṃ;  
sādānesu anādānaṃ,  
tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

yassa rāgo ca doso ca,  
māno makkho ca ohito;

sāsaporiva āraggā,  
tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

akakkasaṃ viññāpaniṃ<sup>8</sup>,  
giraṃ saccaṃ udīraye;

<sup>8</sup>viññāpaniṃ - sīmu, machasaṃ, syā



it is him I call a brahmin.

He who does not take  
what is not given in the  
world,  
whether long or short;  
small or big, beautiful or  
ugly;  
it is him I call a brahmin.

For whom hope is not to  
be found,  
in this world and in the  
other;  
hopeless and detached,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

For whom reliance is not  
to be found,  
having known, without  
perplexity;  
attained to firm footing  
in the deathless,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

yāya nābhisaje<sup>9</sup> kiñci,  
tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

yo ca dīghaṃ ca ras-  
saṃ vā,  
aṇuṃ thūlaṃ subhā-  
subhaṃ;  
loke adinnaṃ nādi-  
yati<sup>10</sup>,  
tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

āsā yassa na vijjanti,  
asmiṃ loke paramhi  
ca;  
nirāsayaṃ<sup>11</sup> viṣaṃyut-  
taṃ,  
tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

yassālayā navijjanti,  
aññāya akathaṅkathī<sup>12</sup>;  
amatogadhaṃ anup-  
pattaṃ,  
tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-

<sup>9</sup>nābhisajje - machasaṃ, syā

<sup>10</sup>nādeti - machasaṃ, syā

<sup>11</sup>nirāsāsaṃ - machasaṃ, syā

<sup>12</sup>akataṅkathī - sīmu.

He who here merit and  
demerit,  
attachment to both he  
has overcome;  
sorrowless, stainless,  
pure,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

Like the moon unblem-  
ished, pure,  
clear and lucid;  
with delight for being  
wholly extincted,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

He who has transcended  
this wandering on in  
delusion,  
an obstruction so hard to  
penetrate;  
the meditator who has  
crossed and gone be-  
yond,  
unperturbed without per-  
plexity;

maṇaṃ.

yodha puññañca pā-  
pañca,  
ubhosaṅgaṃ upac-  
cagā;  
asokaṃ virajaṃ sud-  
dhaṃ,  
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

candaṃva vimalaṃ  
suddhaṃ,  
vipprasannaṃ māvi-  
laṃ;  
nandībhava-parikkhī-  
ṇaṃ,  
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

yo imaṃ paḷipathaṃ  
duggaṃ,  
saṃsāraṃ mohamac-  
cagā;  
tiṇṇo pāragato jhāyī,  
anejo akathaṅkathī;  
anupādāya nibbuto,  
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

without undertakings,  
fully quenched,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

He who having abandoned sensual pleasures here,  
wanders about homeless;  
with delight for sensual pleasures wholly extincted,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

He who having abandoned thirsting here,  
wanders about homeless;  
thirsting in being wholly extincted,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

Having abandoned the human bondage,  
he has overcome the celestial bondage;  
detached from all bondages,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

yodha kāme paha-  
tvāna,  
anāgāro paribbaje;  
kāmaḥavaparikkhī-  
ṇaṃ,  
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

yodha taṇhaṃ paha-  
tvāna,  
anāgāro paribbaje;  
taṇhā bhavaparikkhī-  
ṇaṃ,  
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

hitvā mānusakaṃ yo-  
gaṃ,  
dibbaṃ yogaṃ upa-  
cagā;  
sabbayogavisamū-  
taṃ,  
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇaṃ.

Having abandoned delight and discontent,  
 he has become cool, without ownership;  
 the hero who has conquered all the worlds,  
 it is him I call a brahmin.

He who knows death of beings,  
 and all their arisings;  
 unattached, well-fared, awakened,  
 it is him I call a brahmin.

For he who devas, ghandhabbas and human beings,  
 cannot understand his destiny;  
 The asava-free, the arahant,  
 it is him I call a brahmin.

For he who after and before,  
 and in-between there is

hitvā ratiñca aratiṃ,  
 sītībhūtaṃ nirūpa-  
 dhiṃ;  
 sabbālokābhibhūṃ  
 vīraṃ,  
 tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

cutiṃ yo vedi sattā-  
 naṃ,  
 upapattiñca sabbaso;  
 asattaṃ sugataṃ buddhaṃ,  
 tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

yassa gatiṃ na jānanti,  
 devā gandhabbamānusa;  
 khīṇāsavaṃ arahantaṃ,  
 tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

yassa pure ca pacchāca,  
 majjhe ca natthi kiñ-

not something;  
owning nothing, a dis-  
owner,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

The chief bull, the most  
excellent hero,  
the great seer, victorious;  
the Buddha unperturbed,  
fully cleansed [with the  
inner] bathing,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

He who knows his former  
abodes,  
and sees the heavens and  
the lower worlds;  
then attained to the ex-  
tinction of birth,  
it is him I call a brahmin.

Truly this is a designa-  
tion in the world,  
the assignment of name  
and clan;  
arisen according to com-  
mon usage,  
it is assigned as so and

canam;  
akiñcanam anādā-  
nam,  
tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇam.

usabhaṃ pavaraṃ vī-  
raṃ,  
mahesiṃ vijitāvinam;  
anejaṃ nahātakaṃ  
buddhaṃ,  
tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇam.

pubbenivāsaṃ yo vedi,  
saggāpāyañca pas-  
sati;  
atho jātikkhayaṃ patto,  
tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-  
maṇam.

samaññā'hesā lokas-  
miṃ,  
nāmagottaṃ pakappi-  
taṃ;  
samucca<sup>13</sup> samudāga-  
taṃ,

<sup>13</sup>sammuccā - sīmu. ■

so.

For a long time it has  
persisted,  
those entrenched in views,  
not understanding;  
from not understanding  
they declare to us,  
one is a brahmin by  
birth.

Neither by birth is one a  
brahmin,  
nor by birth is one not a  
brahmin;  
by kamma is one a brah-  
min,  
by kamma is one not a  
brahmin.

By kamma is one a farmer,  
  
by kamma is one a crafts-  
man;  
by kamma is one a mer-  
chant,  
by kamma is one a ser-  
vant.

tattha tattha pakappi-  
taṃ.

dīgharattamanusayi-  
taṃ,  
diṭṭhigatamajānataṃ;  
ajānantā<sup>14</sup> no pabru-  
vanti<sup>15</sup>,  
jātiyā hoti brāhmaṇo.

na jaccā brāhmaṇo<sup>16</sup>  
hoti,  
na jaccā hoti abrāh-  
maṇo<sup>17</sup>;  
kammanā brāhmaṇo<sup>18</sup>  
hoti,  
kammanā hoti abrāh-  
maṇo

kassako kammanā  
hoti,  
sippiko hoti kammanā;

<sup>14</sup>jānantā - sīmu.■

<sup>15</sup>pabrunti - machasaṃ■

<sup>16</sup>vasalo - syā■

<sup>17</sup>pabrunti - machasaṃ■

<sup>18</sup>vasalo - syā■

A thief too, one comes to  
 be by kamma,  
 by kamma is one also a  
 soldier;  
 by kamma is one a sacri-  
 ficing priest,  
 a king too, one comes to  
 be by kamma.

The wise ones see kamma,  
 in just this way as it has  
 come to be;  
 the seers of dependent  
 origination,  
 experts in the results of  
 kamma.

By kamma the world  
 keeps rolling,  
 by kamma the genera-  
 tions turn;  
 beings are bound by  
 kamma,  
 like the linchpin of a  
 travelling chariot.

vāṇijo kammanā hoti,  
 pessiko hoti kammanā.

coropi kammanā hoti,  
 yodhājīvopi kammanā;

yājako kammanā hoti,  
 rājāpi hoti kammanā.

evametaṃ yathābhū-  
 taṃ,  
 kammaṃ passanti  
 paṇḍitā;  
 paṭiccasamuppāda-  
 dasā,  
 kammavipākakovidā.

kammanā vattati loko,

kammanā vattati pajā;

kammanibandhanā  
 sattā,  
 rathassāṇīva yāyato.

By ardency in the life of  
purity,  
by self-control and tam-  
ing;  
by this one is a brahmin,  
this is the brahmin unsur-  
passed.

Endowed with the triple  
knowledges,  
the peaceful one with  
renewal of being ex-  
tinguished;  
know him thus, O Vaset-  
tha,  
as Brahma, the capable  
one who understands  
discriminately.

5. When thus was said, the  
young brahmins Vasettha  
and Bharadvaja said this to  
the Auspicious One: “Excel-  
lent, O Bhante! Excellent, O  
Bhante! Just as, O Bhante,  
one might set upright what  
has been overturned, or open  
up what has been closed, or  
show a path to one who is

tapena brahmacari-  
yena,  
saṃyamena damena  
ca;  
etena brāhmaṇo hoti,  
etaṃ brāhmaṇamutta-  
maṃ.

tīhi vijjāhi sampanno,  
santo khīṇapunab-  
bhavo;  
evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,  
brahmā sakko vijāna-  
tanti.

evaṃ vutte vāseṭṭha-  
bhāradvājā māṇavā  
bhagavantam etada-  
vocaṃ: abhikkantaṃ  
bho gotama, abhik-  
kantaṃ bho gotama,  
seyyathāpi bho go-  
tama, nikkujjitaṃ  
vā ukkujjeyya, pa-  
ṭicchannaṃ vā viva-  
reyya, mūḷhassa vā



lost, or bear an oil lamp in the darkness so that those with good eyesight can see forms, just so has the Dhamma been explained by the venerable Gotama in countless ways. We go, O Bhante, to the Auspicious Gotama, as refuge, and to the Dhamma, and to the Sangha of bhikkhus. May Master Gotama bear it in mind, that we are lay disciples who have gone for refuge from today for as long as life lasts.”

maggam ācikkheyya,  
andhakāre vā tela-  
pajjotaṃ dhāreyya,  
cakkhumanto rūpāni  
dakkhintī'ti. evame-  
vaṃ bhotā gotamena  
anekapariyāyena  
dhammo pakāsito,  
ete mayaṃ bhavan-  
taṃ gotamaṃ sa-  
raṇaṃ gacchāma,  
dhammañca bhik-  
khusaṅghañca. upā-  
sake no bhavaṃ go-  
tamo dhāretu ajja-  
tagge pāṇupetaṃ  
saraṇaṃ gateti.

